SYNEXIA VENTURES

Bridging Southeast Asian Innovation with NTT Group's Global Network

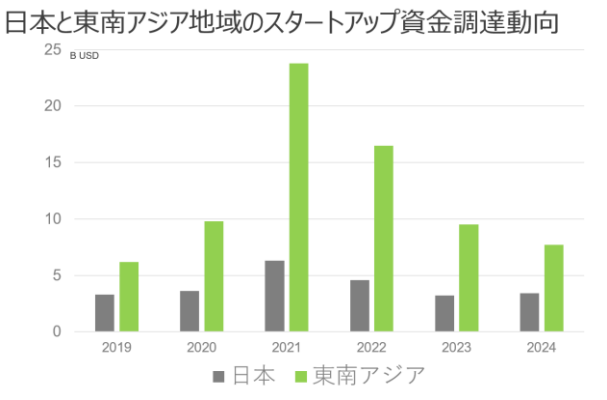
December 2025

Background

- **The Southeast Asian startup market has grown rapidly**, with total investment value and deal volume far exceeding Japan. The region now has **63 unicorns—about four times Japan's total**.
- NTT Group's interest in Southeast Asia is also rising. In 2024, the Group launched the **"NTT Startup Challenge"** to drive collaboration and business creation in the region.

Expansion of the SEA Startup Market

After COVID-19, deal volume and total investment remain higher than in Japan, with growing cross-border capital.
2C sectors, driven by population growth and smartphones, are booming, and activity is now extending into B2B.



Growing Interest of NTT Group Companies in SEA

NTT Startup Challenge

- NTT launched the **"NTT Startup Challenge"** in July 2024 to support collaboration with startups in Southeast Asia.
- In 2025, **15 NTT Group companies** will join, seeking startup partners for new business creation in the region.

NTT EAST

- NTT East made a strategic investment in the Vietnamese startup **AWING in 2024 and** in Indonesia's **SURGE Group in 2025.**

NTT WEST

- Formation of a new task force , with the CEO's initiative focused on the Southeast Asian market in 2025.

NTT docomo

- Establishing the Joint venture in Vietnam for DOOH solution in 2024.
As a next business pillar for NTT DOCOMO Global, the company is exploring opportunities in Southeast Asia such as B2C fintech services.

Background

- NTT Startup Challenge 2025 Pitch Day was held on November 11 in Jakarta, where **10 startups selected from 1,200 applicants** pitched.
- The establishment of **Syenexia Ventures** was officially announced.

Investment Focus

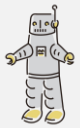
- SYNEXIA Ventures aims at carrying out investment and co-creation activities dedicated to the NTT Group.
- Investment areas are set based on NTT Group companies' priorities and regularly reviewed as needs and market trends evolve.
- We focus on **early-stage investments**, where activity remains strong.
- Target Investment Size of USD 300-500K, up to USD 1M

■Investment Focus Area

AI

IOT

Smart City



Robotics Drone

Agri/ Aquaculture

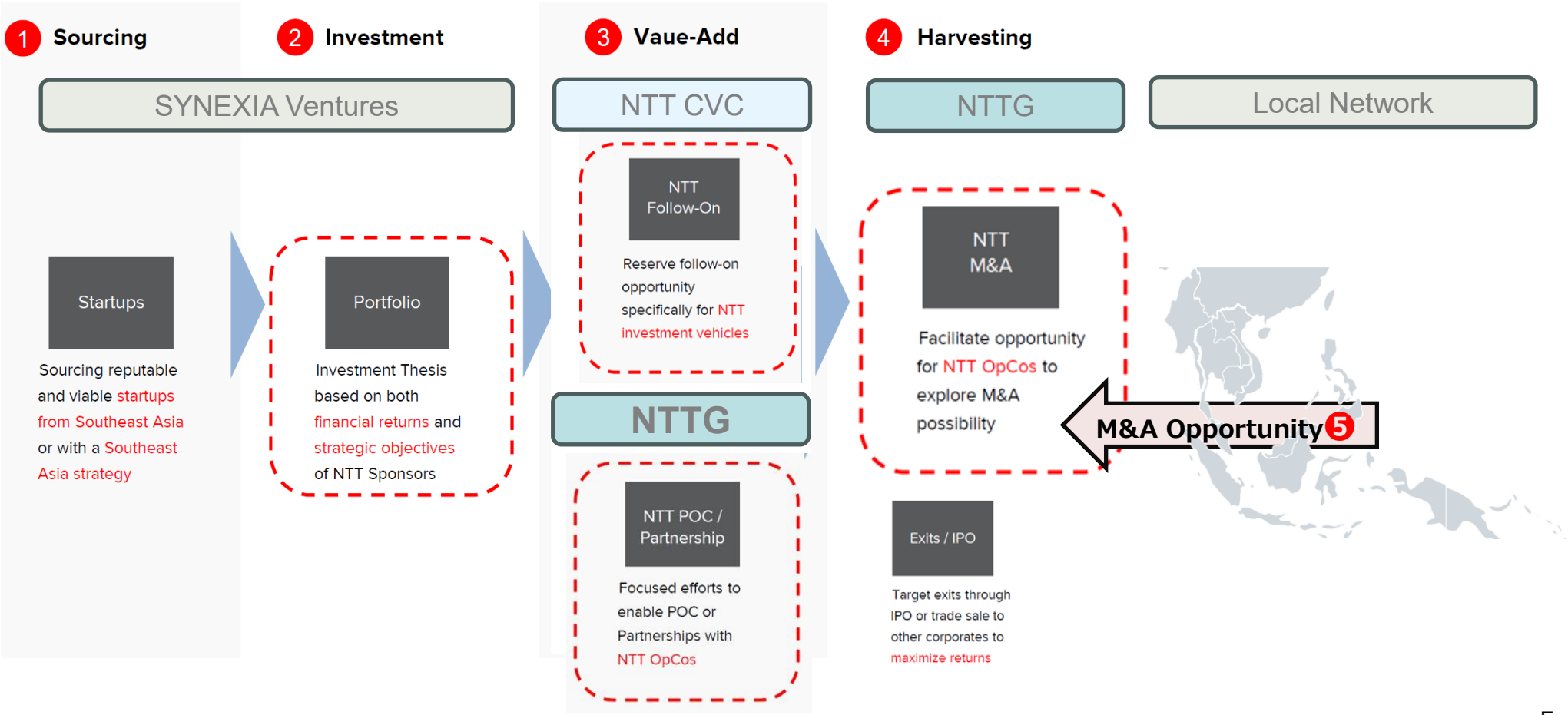
SME Solution

IP Business

Cyber Security

Approach

- SYNEXIA invests in seed & early-stage startups (①②)
- CVC (NTT DOCOMO Ventures and/or NTT Finance) provides follow-on rounds (③)
- Targeting NTTG-driven EXITs (④)
- SYNEXIA sources mid-/late-stage deals & EXIT opportunities (⑤)



Leadership Team

Yuma Kotake, just joined NDV in 2023, is responsible for investment and supports start-ups and portfolio companies in interaction with NTT Groups.

He has more than 10 years of experience as in-house lawyer in NTT DOCOMO and dealt with various domestic/cross border M&A and other strategic alliance.

Prior to joining NDV, he was the General Manager of Business Planning Dept of DOCOMO Insight Marketing Inc. in charge of business strategy and development since 2021.

He loves classic hard rock and heavy metal, such as Gun N Roses, Bon Jovi, Van Halen, MÖTLEY CRÜE. His interest in international business and the English language actually developed as a result of the passion for them.

Kuan Hsu has more than 20 years of experience in diverse industries such as venture capital, private equity, investment banking, supply chain management and management consulting. With a proven track record of successfully leading various deals and supporting portfolio companies in achieving exits through acquisition, Kuan leverages that expertise to search for and invest in promising companies for Synexia Ventures.

Kuan is also the General Partner of KK Fund, an early-stage VC fund based in Singapore. Prior to launching KK Fund, he led GREE Ventures (now known as STRIVE) activities in Southeast Asia. He has held positions as an investment professional at Temasek Holdings, investment banker at Goldman Sachs, Supply Chain Manager at Solectron Corp., and Business Analyst at McKinsey & Co.

Chikashi Sakurada serves as Executive Manager in the Investment Strategy Department at NTT Finance, the financial arm of the NTT Group. In this role, he leads Corporate Venture Capital (CVC) initiatives and direct investment activities, focusing on strategic partnerships that advance global communication infrastructure and digital innovation.

Mr. Sakurada brings extensive financial expertise to the NTT Group, with a background in banking and strategic investment. Prior to joining NTT Finance in 2023, he held senior leadership positions at Mizuho Financial Group, where he served as Deputy General Manager.

Currently, Mr. Sakurada actively manages a portfolio of deep-tech and infrastructure investments. He plays a key role in identifying and supporting high-growth startups that align with NTT's vision for resilient, next-generation connectivity, including recent strategic investments in space-based laser communication technologies.

APPENDIX: NTT Group

• NTT Overview

340,000
Global employees

FORTUNE
#120
Fortune Global 500

50+
Countries and regions

2,300+
Research professionals

$ 90B
Global revenue

IDC
Leader
Data center services marketscape

Top 3
Data center provider

Top 10
Global IT Services Provider

RADAR by Qrator
Top ranked
IP Backbone
Perfect 10 score

A-
S&P Global

150 years
Heritage

22,000
Patents

$ 3B
R&D Investments

(As of March 31, 2025)

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NTT Group Corporate Structure

*Oversea revenue: $19.4B

NTT, Inc. (Holding Company)

・Formulate management strategies for the entire group
・Promotion of Fundamental R&D

Mobile, Domestic IT Service

docomo

Telco (Landline, Fiber)

NTT EAST NTT WEST

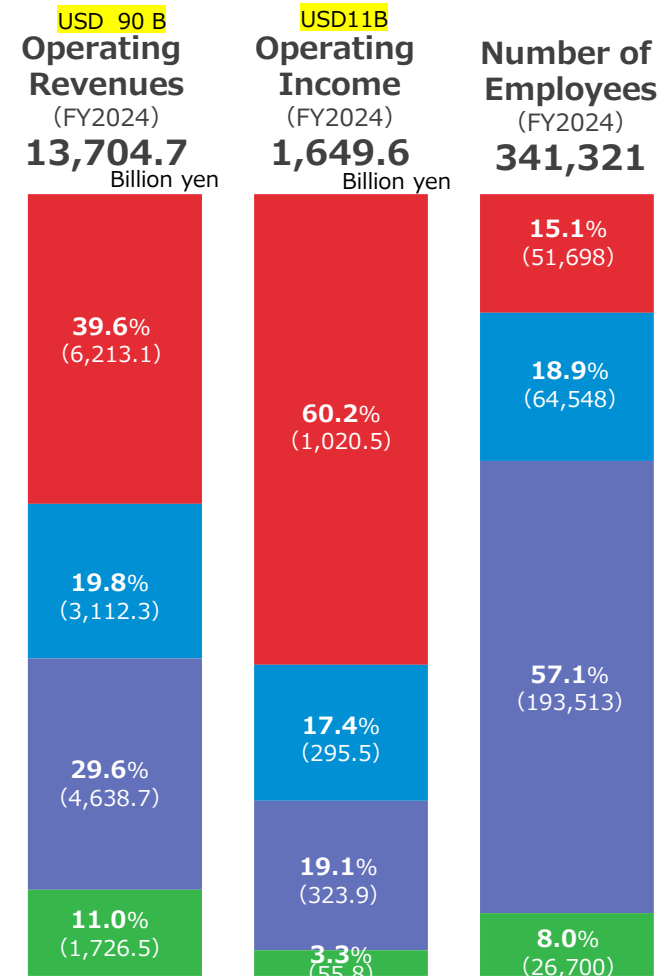
Global IT Service

NTT DATA

Others (Real Estate, Energy and Others)

NTT Urban Solutions NTT Anode Energy

【Ref.】No. of subsidiaries : 992 (348 domestic and 644 overseas) as of Mar. 2025



※ Operating revenue and operating income are percentages of the simple aggregate of each segment (including inter-segment transactions).

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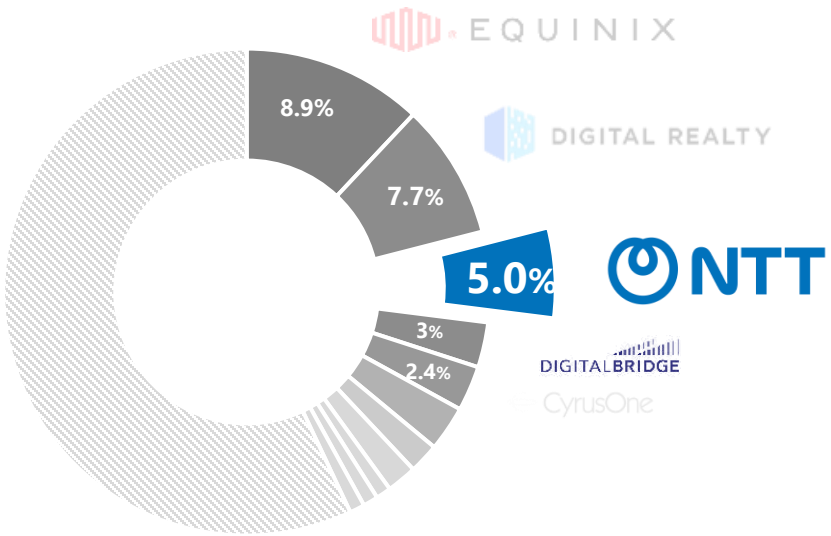
Global standing – IT Service and Datacenter

IT Service market : 8th

Rank	Company	Revenue (M$)
1	Accenture	67,488
2	Amazon	64.131
3	Deloitte	56,785
4	Microsoft	51,499
5	PwC	33,500
6	EY	29,097
7	Tata Consultancy Services	27,387
8	NTT DATA	26,427
9	IBM	24,518
10	Capgemini	22,418

Source: Gartner IT Services Market Share 2024 Report

Data Center Market : 3rd



** Based on Structure Research 2024/7 Report*

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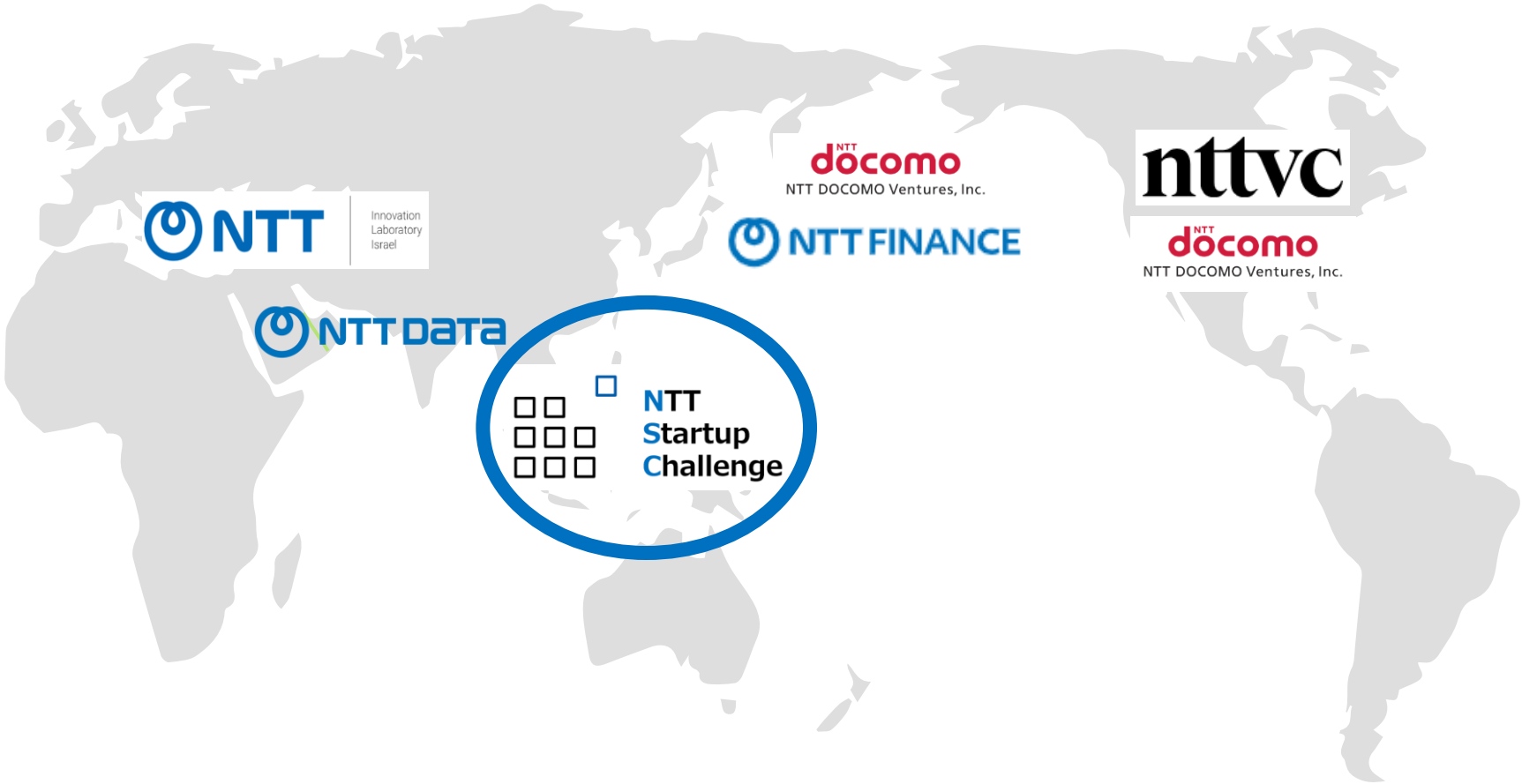
NTT Startup Challenge Launched to Cover Open Innovation White Space within NTT Group



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